

TidyTuesday Week 34

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Thursday 20th August, 2026

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1 Weekly Summary

AI-Generated Content

The summary below was written by Claude (Anthropic) from that week's regression outputs and series descriptions. It has not been reviewed or fact-checked by a human, and should be read as an automated, informal recap – not analysis.

Welcome back to the weekly ritual where we throw two unrelated economic time series into a blender and act shocked at what comes out. This week's contestants included discontinued hospital output indexes, Long Island house prices, government grants, mining price deflators, Canadian recessions, and San Francisco's tech vibes. A truly cohesive lineup that no sane research agenda would ever assemble on purpose. As always: these are randomly paired series, nobody is claiming anything causes anything, and spurious correlation isn't the bug here, it's the whole point.

Monday (August 18) gave us the classic trend mirage in its purest form. Hospital and nursing facility output versus Nassau-Suffolk house prices came in with a gloriously "significant" raw result, an R-squared near 0.60 and a p-value with enough zeros to make you gasp. Truly, at last, proof that hospitals and Long Island real estate are locked in cosmic harmony. Then we detrended it and the whole thing evaporated: R-squared collapsed to 0.08 and the p-value ballooned to 0.23, which is statistics-speak for "never mind." Turns out both series just went up over time, like nearly everything does. Case dismissed.

Tuesday (August 19) barely bothered showing up. U.S. government grants versus a mining sector price deflator managed a limp raw p-value of 0.08 – not even significant if you're being strict, and I am – and once detrended it slumped to a magnificent 0.53. That's the numerical equivalent of a shrug. Nothing here, no trend, no relationship, not even a fun fake one. We salute its honesty and move on.

Then Wednesday (August 20) actually delivered the rare thing this project pretends to be looking for. Canadian recession indicators versus the San Francisco Tech Pulse held up in both the raw and detrended versions, with a negative relationship staying significant after we stripped the trends out (p-value still hovering around one-in-fifty-billion territory). The R-squared is small, so calm down, but directionally it's the kind of thing that even makes a little sense: when Canada's in recession, the broader environment tech thrives in tends to sag too. Do I believe there's a deep structural bond between Ottawa's business cycle and the Bay Area's gadget mood? Absolutely not, and neither should you – but as far as randomly paired discontinued FRED series go, this one earned its gold star. See you next week for more nonsense.

2 Date: 2026-08-18

Series ID: USHSPTLNRSQGSP

This series is titled Quantity Indexes for Real Gross Domestic Product by Industry: Private Industries: Educational Services, Health Care, and Social Assistance: Health Care and Social Assistance: Hospitals and Nursing and Residential Care Facilities for United States (DISCONTINUED) and has a frequency of Annual. The units are Index 2009=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1997-01-01 and the observation end date is 2016-01-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: ATNHPIUS35004Q

This series is titled All-Transactions House Price Index for Nassau County-Suffolk County, NY (MSAD) and has a frequency of Quarterly. The units are Index 1995:Q1=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1975-07-01 and the observation end date is 2026-01-01. The popularity of this series is 21.

2.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_ATNHPIUS35004Q	R-squared:	0.595
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.573
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	26.47
Date:	Tue, 18 Aug 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	6.80e-05
Time:	12:24:41	Log-Likelihood:	-101.38
No. Observations:	20	AIC:	206.8
Df Residuals:	18	BIC:	208.7
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	-202.2530	81.976	-2.467	0.024	-374.478	-30.028
value_fred_USHSPTLNRSQGSP	4.5554	0.885	5.145	0.000	2.695	6.416

Omnibus:	3.374	Durbin-Watson:	0.176
Prob(Omnibus):	0.185	Jarque-Bera (JB):	2.734
Skew:	0.872	Prob(JB):	0.255
Kurtosis:	2.515	Cond. No.	837.

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

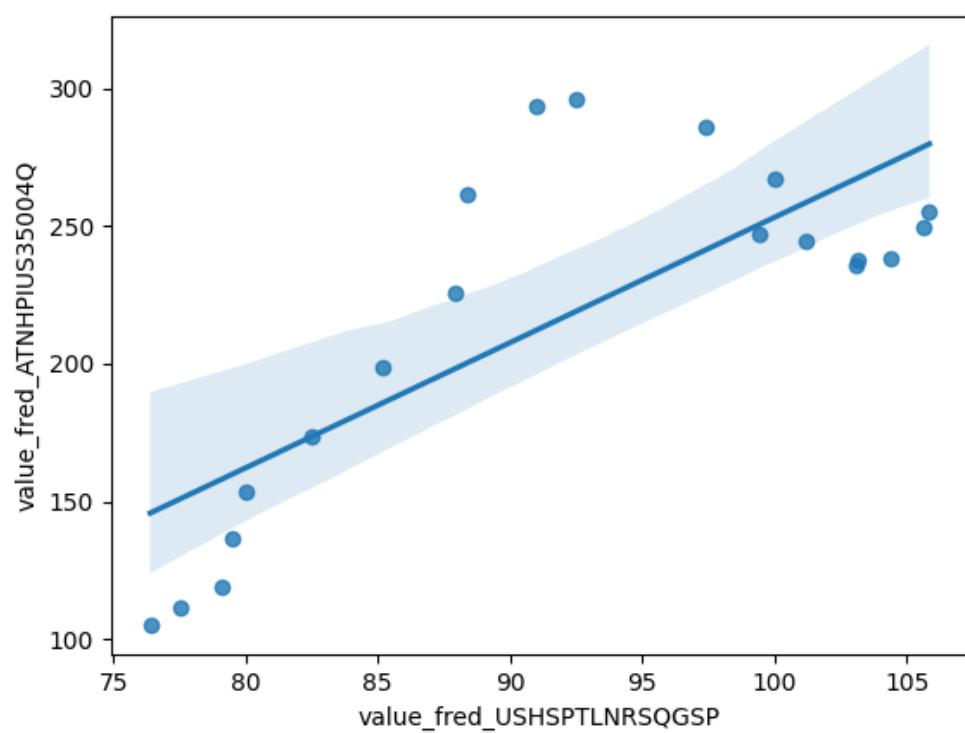


Figure 1: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-08-18

2.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_ATNHPIUS35004Q_detrended	R-squared:	0.079
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.028
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	1.551
Date:	Tue, 18 Aug 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.229
Time:	12:24:41	Log-Likelihood:	-101.26
No. Observations:	20	AIC:	206.5
Df Residuals:	18	BIC:	208.5
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	1.868e-11	9.015	2.07e-12	1.000	-18.941	18.941
value_fred_USHSPTLNRSQGSP_detrended	7.1907	5.773	1.246	0.229	-4.938	19.320

Omnibus:	3.498	Durbin-Watson:	0.209
Prob(Omnibus):	0.174	Jarque-Bera (JB):	2.716
Skew:	0.887	Prob(JB):	0.257
Kurtosis:	2.669	Cond. No.	1.56

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

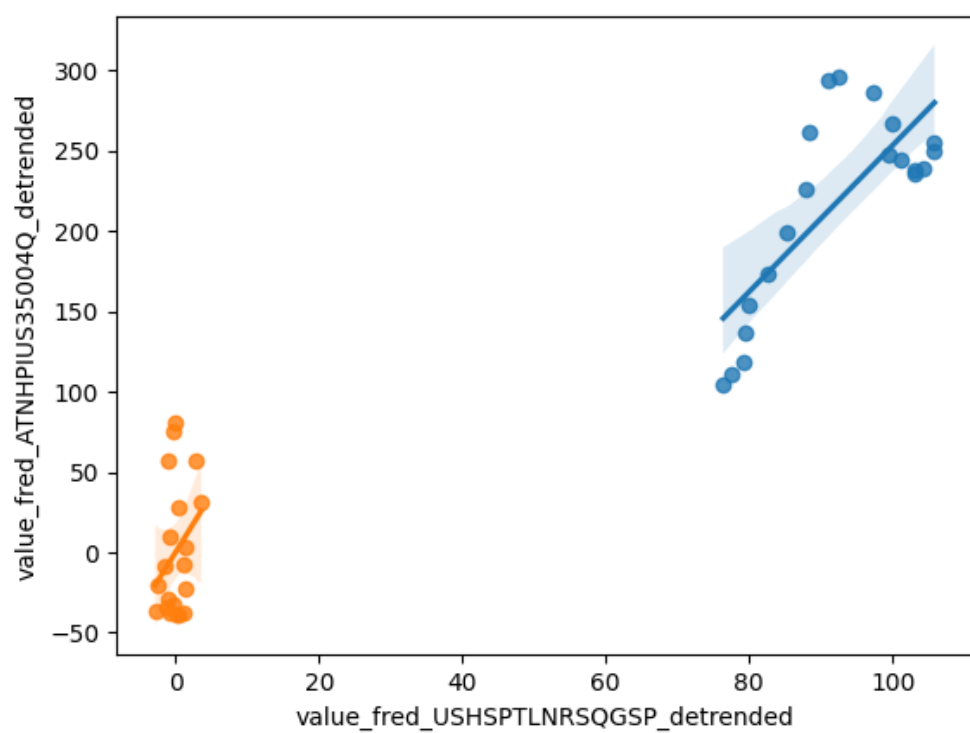


Figure 2: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-08-18

3 Date: 2026-08-19

Series ID: BOPGG

This series is titled U.S. Government Grants Excluding Military (DISCONTINUED) and has a frequency of Quarterly. The units are Billions of Dollars and the seasonal adjustment is Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1960-01-01 and the observation end date is 2014-01-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: IPUBN212T051000000

This series is titled Sectoral Output Price Deflator for Mining: Mining (Except Oil and Gas) (NAICS 212) in the United States and has a frequency of Annual. The units are Percent Change from Year Ago and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1988-01-01 and the observation end date is 2025-01-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

3.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_IPUBN212T051000000	R-squared:	0.117
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.082
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	3.328
Date:	Wed, 19 Aug 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.0801
Time:	12:19:54	Log-Likelihood:	-85.697
No. Observations:	27	AIC:	175.4
Df Residuals:	25	BIC:	178.0
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	1.3198	1.512	0.873	0.391	-1.794	4.434
value_fred_BOPGG	-0.3525	0.193	-1.824	0.080	-0.750	0.045

Omnibus:	2.801	Durbin-Watson:	0.785
Prob(Omnibus):	0.246	Jarque-Bera (JB):	1.507
Skew:	0.532	Prob(JB):	0.471
Kurtosis:	3.454	Cond. No.	10.3

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

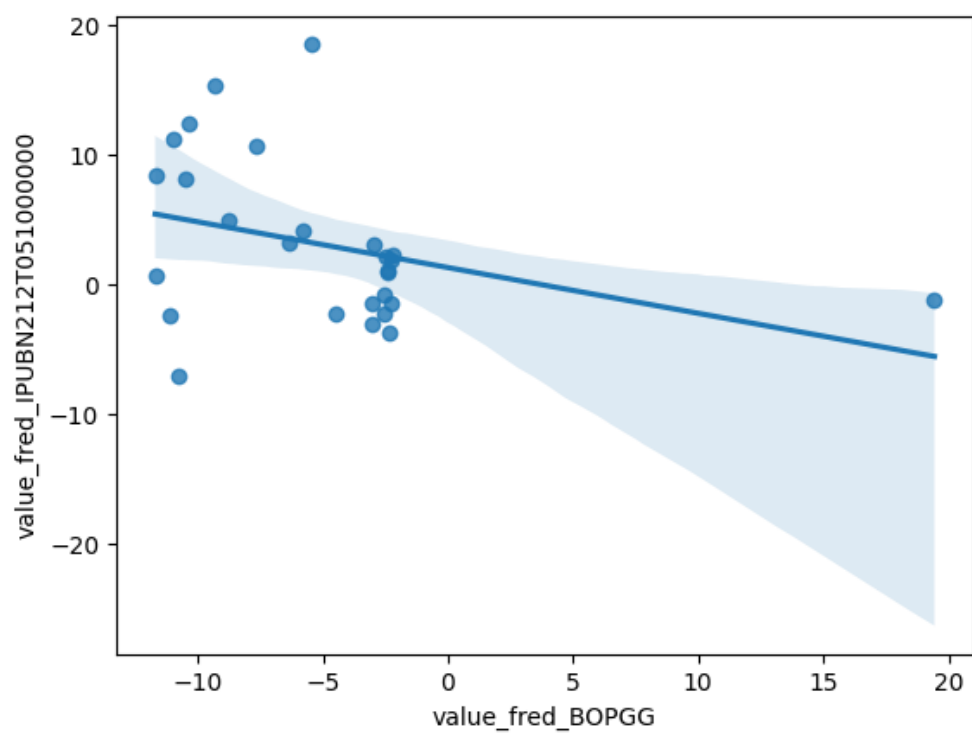


Figure 3: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-08-19

3.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_IPUBN212T051000000_detrended	R-squared:	0.016
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	-0.024
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	0.4017
Date:	Wed, 19 Aug 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.532
Time:	12:19:54	Log-Likelihood:	-85.249
No. Observations:	27	AIC:	174.5
Df Residuals:	25	BIC:	177.1
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	-1.801e-13	1.138	-1.58e-13	1.000	-2.343	2.343
value_fred_BOPGG_detrended	-0.1728	0.273	-0.634	0.532	-0.734	0.389

Omnibus:	2.027	Durbin-Watson:	0.686
Prob(Omnibus):	0.363	Jarque-Bera (JB):	0.803
Skew:	0.236	Prob(JB):	0.669
Kurtosis:	3.700	Cond. No.	4.17

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

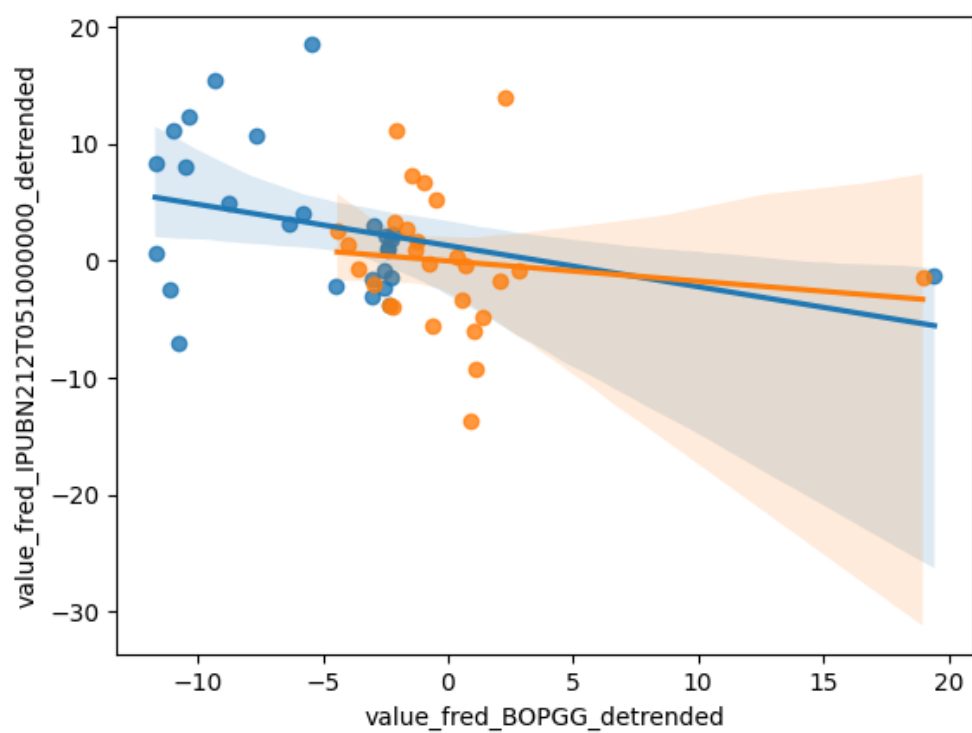


Figure 4: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-08-19

4 Date: 2026-08-20

Series ID: CANRECM

This series is titled OECD based Recession Indicators for Canada from the Peak through the Trough (DISCONTINUED) and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are +1 or 0 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1960-02-01 and the observation end date is 2022-09-01. The popularity of this series is 9.

Series ID: SFTPAGRM158SFRBSF

This series is titled San Francisco Tech Pulse (DISCONTINUED) and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Percent Change at Annual Rate and the seasonal adjustment is Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1971-05-01 and the observation end date is 2020-03-01. The popularity of this series is 6.

4.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_SFTPAGRM158SFRBSF	R-squared:	0.070
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.068
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	43.81
Date:	Thu, 20 Aug 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	8.18e-11
Time:	12:21:40	Log-Likelihood:	184.44
No. Observations:	587	AIC:	-364.9
Df Residuals:	585	BIC:	-356.1
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	0.1539	0.009	16.656	0.000	0.136	0.172
value_fred_CANRECM	-0.0999	0.015	-6.619	0.000	-0.130	-0.070

Omnibus:	7.955	Durbin-Watson:	0.099
Prob(Omnibus):	0.019	Jarque-Bera (JB):	9.420
Skew:	0.172	Prob(JB):	0.00901
Kurtosis:	3.517	Cond. No.	2.43

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

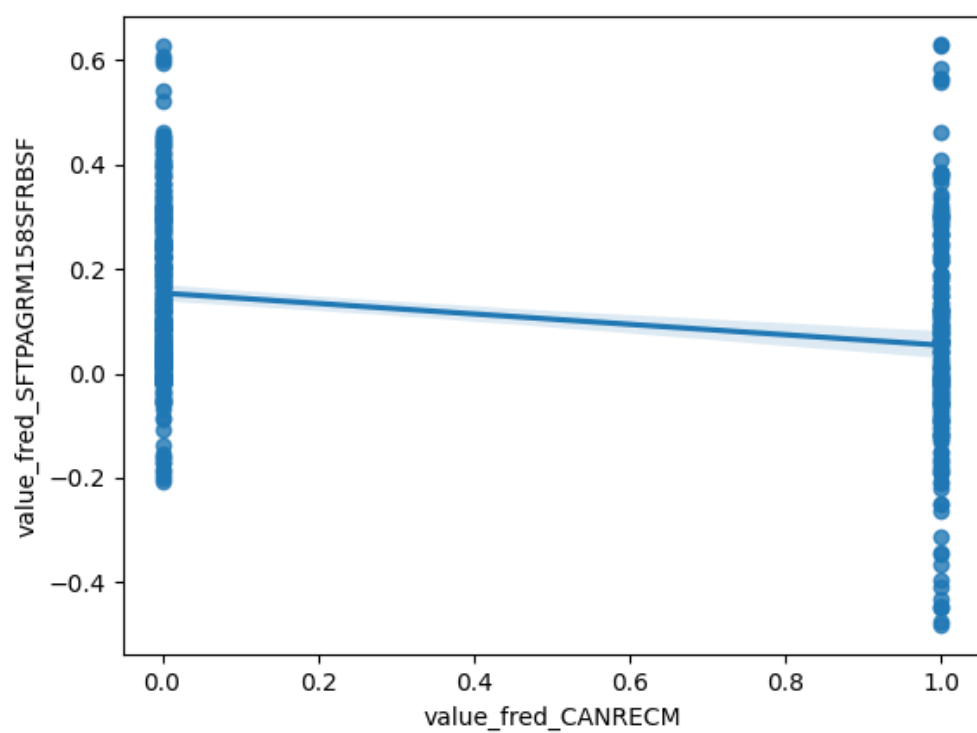


Figure 5: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-08-20

4.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_SFTPAGRM158SFRBSF_detrended	R-squared:	0.074
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.073
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	46.95
Date:	Thu, 20 Aug 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	1.85e-11
Time:	12:21:40	Log-Likelihood:	255.99
No. Observations:	587	AIC:	-508.0
Df Residuals:	585	BIC:	-499.2
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	-1.755e-15	0.006	-2.71e-13	1.000	-0.013	0.013
value_fred_CANRECM_detrended	-0.0917	0.013	-6.852	0.000	-0.118	-0.065

Omnibus:	16.059	Durbin-Watson:	0.124
Prob(Omnibus):	0.000	Jarque-Bera (JB):	17.972
Skew:	-0.338	Prob(JB):	0.000125
Kurtosis:	3.528	Cond. No.	2.07

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

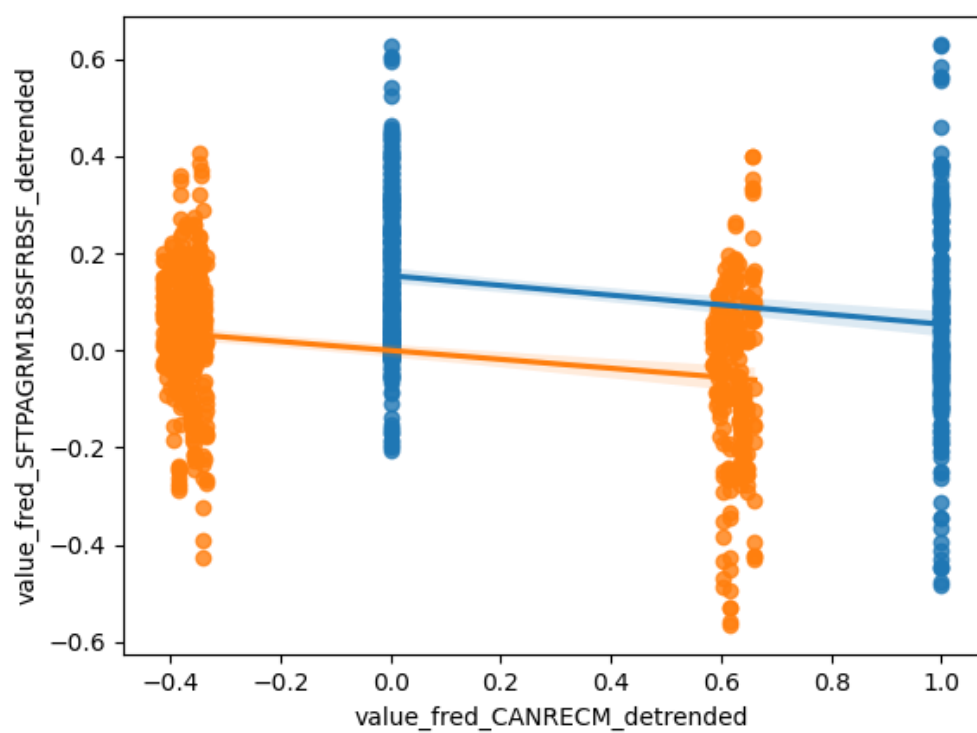


Figure 6: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-08-20